

AP World History: Modern Free-Response Practice Exam 7

APWH-SAQ7-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 2 — Networks of Exchange

Period: c. 1200–1450

Theme: ECN — Economic Systems

Historical Reasoning: Mixed Historical Reasoning

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source 1: Historian Nandi Mbeki, “Great Zimbabwe and Regional Power,” modern historical interpretation, 2020.

“Great Zimbabwe’s power rested on more than impressive stone architecture. Its rulers controlled cattle wealth, agricultural production, gold routes, and access to trade with coastal merchants. Inland political authority and Indian Ocean commerce were closely connected.”

Source 2: Historian Elias Rahman, “Swahili Ports and the Wider Ocean,” modern historical interpretation, 2021.

“The Swahili city-states show how coastal societies could become powerful by linking African resources to Indian Ocean commercial networks. Their rulers and merchants used Islam, architecture, language, and overseas trade to create urban identities that were both African and cosmopolitan.”

- (a) Identify one difference between the two historians’ interpretations of economic power in eastern or southern Africa.
- (b) Describe one specific historical development that could be used to support one of the interpretations.
- (c) Explain one way economic networks in eastern or southern Africa during c. 1200–1450 were similar to or different from economic networks in another region during the same period.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a clear difference between the interpretations, such as Source 1 emphasizing inland political control, cattle, agriculture, and gold routes while Source 2 emphasizes coastal port cities, Islam, urban identity, and Indian Ocean trade.
- (b) 1 point: Describes a relevant development, such as Great Zimbabwe’s stone enclosures, cattle wealth, gold trade, links to Sofala, Swahili city-states, Kilwa, Indian Ocean merchants, Islamic influence, or coastal trade in ivory, gold, and luxury goods.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a valid similarity or difference with another region, such as the Indian Ocean, Trans-Saharan routes, Southeast Asia, Song China, or the Mediterranean, using specific evidence about merchants, states, religion, resources, or trade technologies.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should distinguish inland and coastal forms of economic power without treating them as completely separate. Great Zimbabwe and Swahili ports were connected through resources, merchants, and Indian Ocean demand. For part (c), strong responses should compare a specific feature of exchange, such as commercial taxation, urban ports, religious networks, or control of

valuable resources.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ7-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 3 — Land-Based Empires

Period: c. 1450–1750

Theme: GOV — Governance

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Report from a Mexica tribute official to authorities in Tenochtitlan, central Mexico, c.

1518. This excerpt is original but modeled on the style of tribute and administrative concerns in the late Mexica Empire.

“The town has delivered cotton cloth, cacao, feathers, and maize, but some households claim the last harvest was poor and ask for delay. The local nobles say they remain loyal, yet they complain that warriors and porters are demanded too often. If tribute is reduced, others may imitate them. If tribute is demanded without measure, resentment will grow. The capital depends on order in the provinces, and order depends on fear, honor, and regular payment.”

(a) Identify the likely purpose of the report.

(b) Explain how the report reflects one method used by the Mexica Empire to maintain power.

(c) Explain one limitation of the report as evidence for the experiences of conquered peoples in the Mexica Empire.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Identifies a plausible purpose, such as informing central authorities about tribute collection, warning about resistance, recommending balanced enforcement, or maintaining loyalty and order in a subject town.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant method of Mexica rule, such as tribute collection, military intimidation, use of local nobles, demands for labor or warriors, symbolic authority of Tenochtitlan, or control over provincial resources.

(c) 1 point: Explains a valid limitation, such as the source representing the perspective of an imperial tribute official rather than commoners, women, local religious leaders, enslaved people, or conquered communities; or noting that it may minimize coercion and resentment.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should use the official’s point of view. The report is concerned with keeping tribute flowing and preventing rebellion, so it is useful for understanding imperial administration but limited for understanding the full experience of subject peoples. Strong answers should connect tribute, military power, and local elites as parts of Mexica governance.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ7-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 7 — Global Conflict

Period: c. 1900–present

Theme: GOV — Governance

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Description of a newspaper illustration published in Shanghai in 1901 after the Boxer uprising.

The illustration shows Qing officials seated at a table with representatives of several foreign powers. Behind the foreign representatives are soldiers holding rifles and flags. On the table are papers labeled “indemnity,” “foreign legations,” “railway protection,” and “punishment of officials.” In the background, a damaged gate and burned buildings suggest recent fighting. A caption reads: “Peace after Disorder, Payment after Defeat.”

(a) Identify one political or economic consequence of the Boxer uprising suggested by the described illustration.

(b) Explain one cause of anti-foreign violence in China around 1900.

(c) Explain one way the events suggested by the illustration reflected broader patterns of imperialism in the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Identifies a valid consequence, such as foreign-imposed indemnities, punishment of Qing officials, protection of foreign legations, expanded foreign military presence, railway protection, or weakening of Qing sovereignty.

(b) 1 point: Explains a valid cause of anti-foreign violence, such as resentment against missionaries, unequal treaties, foreign spheres of influence, economic hardship, drought or famine, anger over railways, Qing weakness, or anti-Christian sentiment.

(c) 1 point: Explains a broader imperial pattern, such as foreign powers using military force to demand concessions, protecting economic interests, imposing unequal treaties, weakening sovereignty, controlling infrastructure, or using crises to expand influence.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should interpret the illustration’s symbols: armed foreign representatives, indemnity papers, railway protection, and damaged buildings all suggest coercive diplomacy after conflict. Strong answers should avoid portraying the Boxer uprising as only irrational violence; they should connect it to imperial pressure, social disruption, missionary activity, and Qing weakness.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-DBQ7-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 9 — Globalization

Period: Cross-Period / Transregional

Theme: TEC — Technology and Innovation

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which disease control encouraged new forms of state intervention and international cooperation from c. 1850 to 1950.

Document 1

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Statement by a French delegate at an international sanitary conference, 1851, Paris.

Source Type: Conference statement.

“Steamships and railways have reduced the time between distant ports and European cities. A disease that once traveled slowly with caravans can now arrive before authorities understand its origin. Quarantine rules must therefore be discussed among governments, not invented separately by each port in panic.”

Sourcing cues: Delegate from an industrializing European state; links disease control to transportation technology and international coordination.

Document 2

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Letter from an Ottoman quarantine officer to the Ministry of Health, 1866, Alexandria.

Source Type: Administrative letter.

“Pilgrims, merchants, and sailors arrive from many lands, and each group complains when detained. If inspection is too harsh, trade suffers and officials are accused of disrespecting religion. If inspection is too weak, disease may spread inland. We require trained doctors, clean stations, and rules accepted by foreign consuls as well as local authorities.”

Sourcing cues: Port health official in a major Mediterranean-Red Sea connection point; shows tension between trade, religion, diplomacy, and public health.

Document 3

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Description of a cholera-route map prepared for a public health journal, 1884, London.

Source Type: Described map.

The map uses arrows to show reported cholera outbreaks moving from South Asia through Red Sea ports, Mediterranean shipping lanes, and European railway connections. Major ports are marked with black circles, while inland rail junctions are marked with squares. A note below the map states: “Modern transportation makes local disease a matter of international concern.”

Sourcing cues: Medical-publication visual source; presents disease spread through transportation networks and encourages professional public health responses.

Document 4

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Report from a British colonial medical officer during a plague outbreak, 1897, Bombay.

Source Type: Colonial medical report.

“House inspections, hospital removals, and disinfection teams are necessary to stop contagion. Yet many residents hide the sick because they fear separation from family, religious offense, or loss of

wages. Public health cannot succeed by police power alone, but delay allows the disease to spread through the city.”

Sourcing cues: Colonial medical official; emphasizes disease control but reveals local resistance to intrusive state measures.

Document 5

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Description of a public health poster issued by a municipal government, 1918, Buenos Aires.

Source Type: Described poster.

The poster shows a crowded tram, a coughing passenger, and a nurse pointing toward an open window. Below are instructions: “Avoid crowds when ill. Cover coughs. Report fever. Protect workers and families.” The poster includes symbols for factories, schools, and streetcars, suggesting that urban life requires public cooperation during influenza outbreaks.

Sourcing cues: Municipal public education poster; uses simple instructions to encourage mass participation in disease prevention.

Document 6

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Memorandum from the League of Nations Health Organization, 1925, Geneva.

Source Type: International organization memorandum.

“Reliable reporting of epidemics requires cooperation among ports, telegraph offices, laboratories, and ministries. Delayed information endangers neighboring states and trade partners alike. The Health Organization will collect data, circulate warnings, and encourage standard methods for vaccination, quarantine, and laboratory confirmation.”

Sourcing cues: International organization perspective; emphasizes technical expertise, communication, and standardized reporting.

Document 7

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Statement from a World Health Organization planning committee, 1948, Geneva.

Source Type: International planning statement.

“Health is no longer a matter of charity after disaster. It is a responsibility of governments and a concern of the international community. Epidemic control, vaccination, nutrition, sanitation, and medical training must be coordinated so that poorer countries are not left as reservoirs of preventable disease.”

Sourcing cues: Post-World War II international health perspective; frames health as a government responsibility and global development issue.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which disease control encouraged new state intervention and international cooperation from c. 1850 to 1950. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning, such as arguing that faster transportation and epidemic threats expanded government regulation, public education,

medical bureaucracy, and international health institutions, while also creating conflicts over trade, religion, colonial power, and personal liberty.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader historical context relevant to disease control, such as industrialization, steamship travel, railway expansion, urbanization, imperialism, migration, pilgrimage routes, public health science, germ theory, World War I, influenza, the League of Nations, World War II, or the creation of new international organizations.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point by accurately using the content of at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points by using at least six documents to support an argument about quarantine, transportation, state health intervention, colonial medicine, public education, epidemic reporting, laboratories, vaccination, or international health institutions.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by using at least one specific piece of relevant outside evidence not found in the documents, such as germ theory, Louis Pasteur, Robert Koch, the Suez Canal, the 1918 influenza pandemic, smallpox vaccination campaigns, urban sanitation reforms, colonial plague measures in India, the League of Nations, or the creation of the World Health Organization.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. Effective examples include explaining why port officials balanced trade and quarantine, why colonial medical officers emphasized police power and resistance, why posters used simple public instructions, why international organizations focused on reporting standards, or why postwar planners framed health as a global responsibility.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a more complex understanding of disease control. This may include explaining that public health expanded state power while also requiring popular cooperation, that international cooperation protected both lives and commerce, that colonial medicine could combine health goals with coercive authority, or that disease control shifted from emergency quarantine toward broader ideas of development, sanitation, vaccination, and medical training.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ could argue that disease control from c. 1850 to 1950 encouraged states to intervene more directly in travel, cities, homes, hospitals, reporting systems, and public education, while also encouraging international cooperation through conferences and health organizations. Documents 1, 2, 3, and 6 support arguments about transportation, quarantine, and international reporting.

Documents 4 and 5 support arguments about state intervention and public cooperation or resistance.

Document 7 shows the broader postwar shift toward health as a global responsibility. Outside evidence could include germ theory, Pasteur, Koch, the Suez Canal, the 1918 influenza pandemic, smallpox vaccination, urban sanitation, or the WHO. Strong sourcing should compare the priorities of diplomats, port officers, colonial doctors, municipal governments, and international health planners.

Expected Points:

7

APWH-LEQ7-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 6 — Consequences of Industrialization

Period: c. 1750–1900

Theme: ECN — Economic Systems

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

Although Great Britain industrialized first, industrialization spread unevenly to other regions during

the nineteenth century. Some states and societies adopted factories, railroads, heavy industry, banking systems, protective tariffs, or technical education to compete in a rapidly changing global economy.

Evaluate the extent to which industrialization outside Great Britain changed global economic and political power in the period c. 1750 to 1900.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which industrialization outside Great Britain changed global economic and political power from c. 1750 to 1900. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning about how industrialization shifted or reinforced power among states and regions.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader context relevant to industrialization outside Great Britain, such as the Industrial Revolution, coal and steam power, global markets, imperial competition, nationalism, state-sponsored modernization, railroad construction, protective tariffs, or the demand for raw materials and manufactured goods.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point by identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as German industrial growth, U.S. steel and railroads, Japanese Meiji industrialization, Russian railway construction, Belgian or French industry, protective tariffs, state banks, technical schools, or military-industrial production. Earns 2 points by using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about changing global economic or political power.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by using causation to explain how industrialization outside Great Britain affected power. Strong responses might explain that industrialization allowed some states to challenge British dominance, build stronger militaries, expand overseas influence, increase exports, or strengthen centralized states, while nonindustrial regions became more vulnerable to imperialism or unequal trade.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced understanding of uneven industrialization. This may include explaining that industrialization strengthened some late-industrializing states but did not eliminate British power, that state policy mattered more in some regions than others, that industrial power increased imperial competition, or that industrialization deepened inequalities between industrial and nonindustrial regions.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should not simply describe British industrialization. It should focus on industrialization outside Great Britain and explain how it changed global power. Useful evidence might include German heavy industry, U.S. railroads and steel, Japanese state-led industrialization, Russian railway building, French or Belgian industry, protective tariffs, technical education, and military-industrial production. Strong responses should connect industrial growth to global consequences, such as new imperial rivalries, stronger militaries, changing export competition, and widening gaps between industrialized and nonindustrialized regions.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APWH-FRQ7

· APWH-SAQ7-001: Unit 2 — Networks of Exchange; c. 1200–1450; eastern and southern Africa including Great Zimbabwe, Swahili city-states, Kilwa, Sofala, inland gold routes, and Indian Ocean connections; secondary text source with two modern historians; source perspectives contrast inland power based on cattle, agriculture, gold routes, and political authority with coastal Swahili power based on port cities, Islam, architecture, language, and Indian Ocean trade; historical development

is eastern/southern African economic networks and state formation; reasoning path compares inland-resource and coastal-maritime interpretations and links regional trade to wider exchange networks; misconception targeted: African trade states were either isolated inland societies or purely coastal merchant communities without inland-coastal connections.

· APWH-SAQ7-002: Unit 3 — Land-Based Empires; c. 1450–1750; Mexica Empire / Tenochtitlan and central Mexican tribute provinces; primary text source is an original tribute official report; source perspective is an imperial administrator concerned with tribute, loyalty, local nobles, labor demands, and provincial resentment; historical development is Mexica tribute extraction, provincial control, military intimidation, and use of local elites; reasoning path focuses on purpose, governance method, and source limitation for conquered peoples; misconception targeted: the Mexica Empire was held together only by ritual power or only by military conquest without administrative tribute systems.

· APWH-SAQ7-003: Unit 7 — Global Conflict; c. 1900–present; late Qing China / Boxer uprising and foreign intervention; non-text source type is a described Shanghai newspaper illustration after the Boxer uprising; visual/data/map pattern includes Qing officials, foreign representatives, soldiers, flags, damaged buildings, and papers labeled indemnity, foreign legations, railway protection, and punishment of officials; historical development is anti-foreign violence, imperial intervention, Boxer Protocol consequences, indemnities, and weakened Qing sovereignty; reasoning path is causation from imperial pressure and domestic crisis to anti-foreign violence and coercive post-conflict settlement; misconception targeted: the Boxer uprising was only irrational xenophobia or only a local riot without connection to imperialism and sovereignty.

· APWH-DBQ7-001: Unit 9 — Globalization; Cross-Period / Transregional; Europe, Ottoman Mediterranean, Alexandria, South Asia-linked cholera routes, Bombay, Buenos Aires, Geneva, and global health institutions; DBQ topic is disease control encouraging state intervention and international cooperation from c. 1850 to 1950; document types include international sanitary conference statement, Ottoman quarantine officer letter, described cholera-route map, British colonial medical report, described influenza public health poster, League of Nations Health Organization memorandum, and World Health Organization planning statement; document perspectives include European diplomats, port quarantine officials, medical journal authors, colonial doctors, municipal public educators, international health administrators, and postwar global health planners; main argument paths include quarantine, transportation networks, steamships, railways, urbanization, colonial public health, public education, disease reporting, laboratories, vaccination, international standards, and health as development; outside evidence possibilities include germ theory, Pasteur, Koch, Suez Canal, 1918 influenza, smallpox vaccination, urban sanitation reforms, colonial plague measures in India, League of Nations, and WHO creation; sourcing opportunities include European fear of faster disease travel, port balancing of trade/religion/health, medical map advocacy, colonial coercion and resistance, municipal poster audience, League technical reporting goals, and WHO postwar development framing.

· APWH-LEQ7-001: Unit 6 — Consequences of Industrialization; c. 1750–1900; industrialization outside Great Britain with possible evidence from Germany, United States, Japan, Russia, France, Belgium, and other late-industrializing states; LEQ topic is industrialization outside Britain changing global economic and political power; historical reasoning process is causation; evidence categories include German heavy industry, U.S. steel and railroads, Meiji industrialization, Russian railways, protective tariffs, state banks, technical schools, military-industrial production, export competition, imperial rivalries, and unequal trade; complexity path weighs new industrial challengers against continued British influence and explains uneven industrialization, state policy, military power, imperial competition, and widening gaps between industrialized and nonindustrialized regions; misconception targeted: industrialization remained only a British phenomenon or spread evenly without major geopolitical consequences.